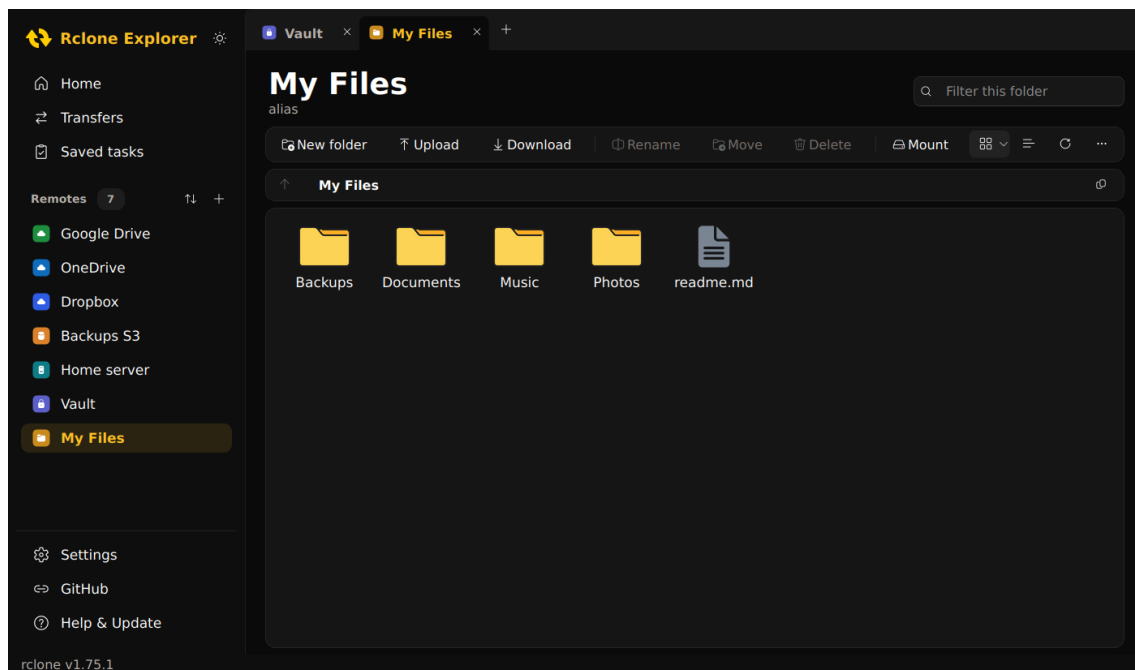




# Rclone Explorer

User Guide - Version 5.0.0

The rclone GUI for Windows: browse, transfer and sync all your cloud storage



Rclone Explorer in dark mode: tabs, command bar, breadcrumb and the Icons view.

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# Getting started

Rclone Explorer is a portable rclone GUI for Windows and Linux. rclone is the command line tool that connects to more than 70 cloud storage services; Rclone Explorer gives it a full graphical interface. It needs no installation and does not change anything on your PC outside its own folder.

## Requirements

- Windows 10 (version 1809 or newer) or Windows 11, 64-bit, or a 64-bit Linux distribution (Ubuntu, Fedora, Debian, Mint, Arch and others).
- About 150 MB of disk space for the app and the bundled rclone.
- Optional: **WinFsp** (winfsp.dev) on Windows or **FUSE 3** on Linux to mount remotes as drives.
- Optional: a media player such as **VLC** for streaming.

## Installing

- Download **RcloneExplorer-5.0.0-windows-x64.zip** from the Releases page of the GitHub repository.
- Optionally verify the download: the release also contains **SHA256SUMS.txt**. In PowerShell run `Get-FileHash .\RcloneExplorer-5.0.0-windows-x64.zip` and compare the value.
- Right-click the zip, choose **Extract All**, and pick any folder: Documents, D:\Tools or a USB stick all work.
- Run **RcloneExplorer.exe**. Because the app is not code-signed, Windows may show Windows protected your PC: click **More info**, then **Run anyway**. This is needed only once.

## Installing on Linux

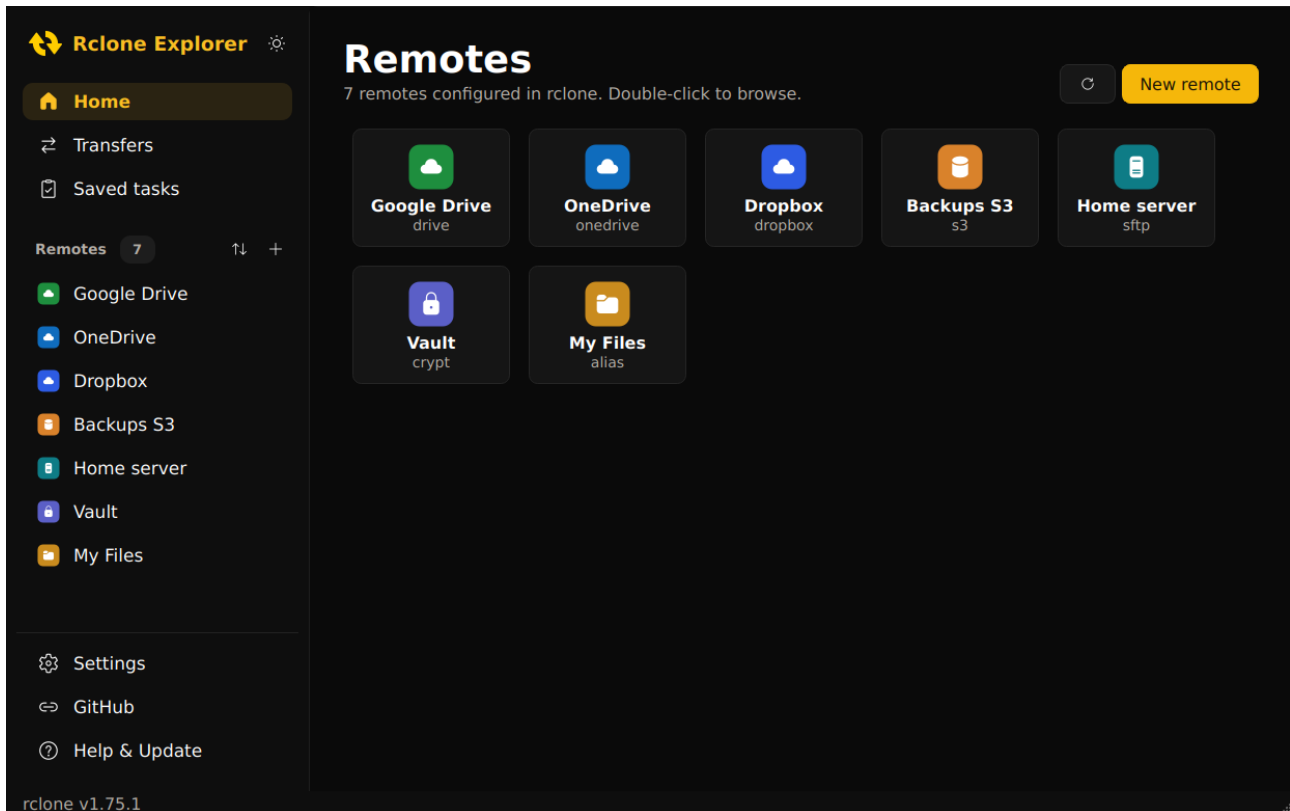
- Download **RcloneExplorer-5.0.0-linux-x86\_64.AppImage** from the Releases page.
- Make it executable: `chmod +x RcloneExplorer-*.AppImage`, or in your file manager Properties > Allow executing as program.
- Run it. If it does not start, install FUSE 2 (libfuse2t64 on Ubuntu 24.04 and newer, libfuse2 on older releases) or start it with `--appimage-extract-and-run`.
- Settings are stored in `~/.config/rclone-browser`. For a portable setup, create a folder named like the AppImage plus **.config** next to it.

## First start

Your existing rclone remotes appear automatically. If you have never used rclone, click **New remote** on the Home page (or the **+** next to Remotes in the sidebar). This opens rclone's setup assistant in a console window, which asks for the storage type and guides you through signing in. When it finishes, the new remote appears in the app.

**Tip** If rclone itself is missing, the app offers to download the latest official version for you. The download is checksum-verified before it is used.

# The window at a glance



The Home page with remote cards (dark mode).

| Area                 | What it does                                                                                                                                                                          |
|----------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Sidebar: Home        | Overview of all remotes as cards. Double-click a card to browse it.                                                                                                                   |
| Sidebar: Transfers   | Running and finished copies, syncs, mounts and streams. The gold number shows how many are running.                                                                                   |
| Sidebar: Saved tasks | Saved transfers that you can run again.                                                                                                                                               |
| Sidebar: Remotes     | Every configured remote with its service tile. Click to open it; right-click for Open in new tab, Close all tabs and Reload remotes. The number is the remote count, + adds a remote. |
| Sun / moon icon      | Next to the app name: switches between light and dark.                                                                                                                                |
| Sidebar footer       | <b>Settings</b> , <b>GitHub</b> (project page) and <b>Help &amp; Update</b> (rclone updates, About, Quit).                                                                            |
| Status bar           | The rclone version on the left, followed by messages. When an update is available the version becomes a clickable link.                                                               |

# Remotes

A remote is one storage location configured in rclone, for example your Google Drive, a OneDrive account, an S3 bucket or an SFTP server. Rclone Explorer reads them from rclone's configuration file.

## Adding, editing and removing remotes

Click **New remote**. rclone's assistant opens in a console window and offers n (new remote), e (edit), d (delete), r (rename) and more. After closing it, the sidebar and Home page refresh automatically; use the refresh button on the Home page if not.

## Service tiles

Each remote is shown with a colour-coded tile for its storage type, for example green for Google Drive, blue for OneDrive and teal for pCloud. You can replace any tile with your own picture; see Custom remote icons.

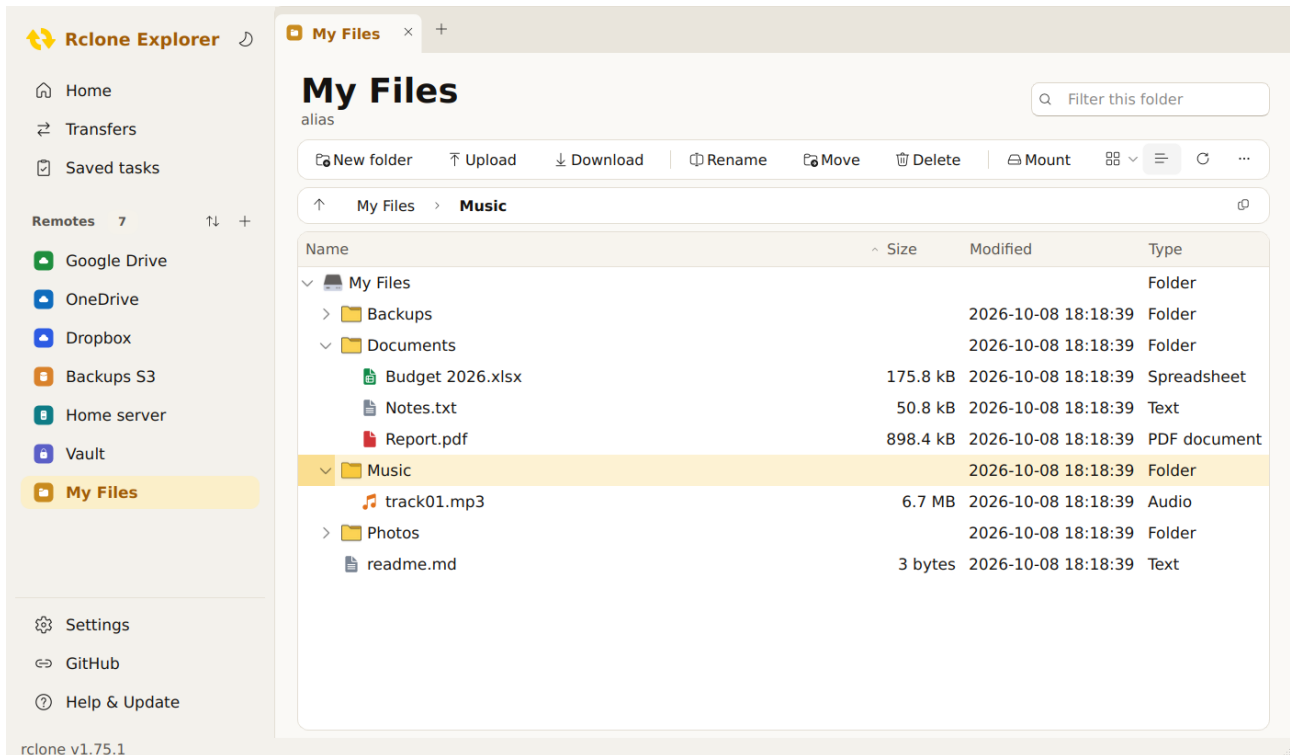
## Sorting remotes

The sort button next to Remotes in the sidebar orders them by configuration order, name (A-Z or Z-A) or type. Choose **Custom** to drag them into your own order; it is remembered.

## Encrypted configuration

If your rclone configuration is password-protected, the app asks for the password once per session. It is kept only in memory and passed to rclone through an environment variable, never on the command line and never written to disk.

# Browsing files



Details view in light mode with colour-coded file icons.

## Tabs

- Clicking a remote in the sidebar opens it in a tab, or switches to it if already open.
- **Ctrl+T** or the **+** button opens the current remote in another tab, for example to compare two folders.
- Tabs work like File Explorer's: the selected tab merges into the page, and **+** right after the last tab opens a new one.
- Close a tab with its **X**, **Ctrl+W**, or a middle-click. Tabs can be dragged to reorder them.

## Icons and Details views

The two buttons at the right of the command bar switch the view. **Icons** (Ctrl+Shift+1) shows large icons; double-click a folder or press Enter to open it. The small arrow next to the Icons button chooses Extra large, Large, Medium or Small icons, and Ctrl + mouse wheel zooms between them. **Details** (Ctrl+Shift+2) shows a tree with size, modification date and type; click a column header to sort, right-click it to also show Extension and Path. The choice is remembered.

## Command bar

When the window is narrow, the less used buttons and then all buttons show only their icons; hover over an icon to see its name. Google Drive remotes have **Show files shared with me** in the More (...) menu.

## Address bar and filter

- The breadcrumb shows where you are; click any part to jump there. The **Up** arrow (Alt+Up) goes to the parent folder; the copy button copies the path in rclone notation (remote:path).
- **Filter this folder** (Ctrl+F) hides items whose names do not contain the text you type. Esc clears it.

## File type icons

Folders are yellow; images teal; video purple; audio orange; archives brown; PDFs red; Word documents blue; spreadsheets green; presentations orange-red; code indigo; programs blue; everything else grey.

# Working with files

Select one or more items, then use the command bar, the right-click menu or a keyboard shortcut.

| Command                | Shortcut | What happens                                                                                                         |
|------------------------|----------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| New folder             | F7       | Creates a folder in the current folder.                                                                              |
| Upload                 | Ctrl+U   | Opens the transfer dialog to copy files from your PC. You can also drag files from File Explorer onto the file list. |
| Download               | Ctrl+D   | Opens the transfer dialog to copy the selection to your PC.                                                          |
| Rename                 | F2       | Renames the selected file or folder on the remote.                                                                   |
| Move                   |          | Moves the selection to another folder on the same remote.                                                            |
| Delete                 | Del      | Deletes the selection after confirmation. This cannot be undone.                                                     |
| Mount                  |          | Makes the folder available as a drive letter (needs WinFsp).                                                         |
| More: Stream           |          | Plays a media file in your player without downloading it first.                                                      |
| More: Folder size      |          | Counts files and total size (runs on the remote).                                                                    |
| More: Folder tree      |          | Shows the folder structure as text.                                                                                  |
| More: Export file list |          | Saves a list of files as text or CSV.                                                                                |
| More: Copy public link |          | Creates a sharing link where the service supports it.                                                                |
| Refresh                | F5       | Reloads the current folder.                                                                                          |

## The transfer dialog

Upload, Download and Tasks share one dialog. **Mode** chooses Copy (keep source), Move (delete source afterwards) or Sync (make the destination identical, which can delete files there). **Skip files** and **Compare** control which files are transferred. The Transfer tab sets parallel transfers, bandwidth limits and timeouts; Exclude takes rclone filter patterns such as \*.tmp. **Run** (Enter) starts the transfer, **Dry run** only shows what would happen, **Save task** stores the settings.

**Important** Always try a **Dry run** before a **Sync**: sync deletes files on the destination that are not in the source.

# Transfers



A running transfer with statistics tiles and per-file progress.

- The coloured pill shows the state: **Running** (gold), **Paused** (grey), **Finished** (green) or **Error** (red). Click it to show or hide the details.
- The header line shows progress, speed and time left even when the card is collapsed.
- **Pause / Resume** (the pause and play buttons) freezes the rclone process and continues it later. Very long pauses can make some services drop the connection; rclone then retries automatically.
- The copy button copies the equivalent rclone command line, handy for scripts.
- The **X** button cancels a running transfer (after confirmation) or removes a finished one. **Show Output** displays rclone's full log.
- The tiles show transferred and total size, speed, time left, elapsed time, files, checks and errors.

## CHAPTER 7

# Tasks

A task is a saved transfer: source, destination and all options. Use tasks for jobs you repeat, such as a weekly backup.

- Create one with **Save task** in the transfer dialog, and give it a description.
- On the Saved tasks page select a task and choose **Run**, **Dry run**, **Edit** or **Delete**.
- Tasks are stored in **tasks.bin** in the app folder (portable mode).

## CHAPTER 8

# Mounting and streaming

## Mount a remote as a drive

Install WinFsp from [winfsp.dev](http://winfsp.dev), then select a folder and click **Mount**. The remote appears in File Explorer under a free drive letter. The mount is listed under Transfers; cancel it there to unmount. Default options (for example `--vfs-cache-mode writes`) are set in Settings.

## Stream media

Set **Stream command** in Settings, for example `"C:\Program Files\VideoLAN\VLC\vlc.exe"` -, then use **More (...)** > **Stream** on a video or audio file.

# Settings and themes

Open **Settings** at the bottom of the sidebar. The sun / moon icon next to the app name switches between light and dark instantly.

| Setting                           | Meaning                                                                                                                                      |
|-----------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| rclone location                   | Path to rclone.exe. In portable mode: rclone/rclone.exe.                                                                                     |
| rclone.conf location              | Path to rclone's configuration. Empty = rclone's default (%APPDATA%\rclone\rclone.conf), or rclone\rclone.conf in the app folder if present. |
| Stream command                    | Player command line used by Stream.                                                                                                          |
| Mount options                     | Extra rclone options for Mount.                                                                                                              |
| Default download / upload folder  | Folder pre-filled in the transfer dialog.                                                                                                    |
| Default download / upload options | Extra rclone options for those transfers, e.g. <code>--bwlimit 5M</code> .                                                                   |
| Default rclone options            | Added to every rclone call, e.g. <code>--fast-list</code> .                                                                                  |
| Check for rclone updates          | Daily check with an offer to install.                                                                                                        |
| System tray                       | Always show the tray icon, close to tray, notify about finished transfers.                                                                   |
| User interface                    | Theme (Same as Windows / Light / Dark), file and folder icons, alternating row colours, hidden files.                                        |
| Proxy                             | Use the system's internet settings or a manual http/https proxy for rclone. Restart the app after changing.                                  |

## Portable mode and where files are stored

The release is portable: the file **RcloneExplorer.ini** next to the exe switches portable mode on. Everything the app writes stays in its folder, and paths are stored relative to it, so the folder can be moved or copied to another PC.

| What                 | Location                                                                                                |
|----------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| rclone               | rclone\rclone.exe                                                                                       |
| rclone configuration | %APPDATA%\rclone\rclone.conf by default; put a copy in rclone\rclone.conf to take your remotes with you |
| Settings             | RcloneExplorer.ini                                                                                      |
| Saved tasks          | tasks.bin                                                                                               |
| Custom remote icons  | icons\remotes\                                                                                          |
| Documentation        | docs\ (README, changelog, license, this guide)                                                          |
| Qt plugins           | qt\plugins (found via qt.conf)                                                                          |

**Security** rclone.conf contains access tokens for your cloud accounts. If you carry it on a USB stick, protect it with rclone's own config encryption (run rclone config and choose s, then set a configuration password).

### Non-portable use

Delete RcloneExplorer.ini to store settings in the registry (HKEY\_CURRENT\_USER\Software\rclone-browser) and tasks in %LOCALAPPDATA%\rclone-browser instead.

## Keeping rclone up to date

- Once a day the app checks downloads.rclone.org (GitHub as fallback) and offers **Update now**, **Skip this version** or **Later**.
- Check manually via **Help & Update > Check for rclone updates**; switch the daily check off in the same menu or in Settings.
- Downloads come only over HTTPS, are verified against rclone's published SHA-256 checksums, and the new rclone.exe must run and report the expected version before it replaces the old one.
- Updating while transfers or mounts run is safe; they finish with the previous version.

# Custom remote icons

To use your own picture for a storage type, put a file named after the rclone type into **icons\remotes** next to RcloneExplorer.exe, then restart or use Reload remotes.

- Logos for Box, Drime, Dropbox, Filen, Google Drive, Koofr, Mega, OneDrive, pCloud, Proton Drive and S3 are included.
- Formats: **.png**, **.svg** or **.ico** (PNG wins if several exist). Square, ideally SVG or 256 x 256 px PNG with transparency.
- The icon applies to every remote of that type. The type is shown under each remote's name on the Home page.
- Most worth customising: cloud drives, photo services and object storage. Virtual types (alias, crypt, union and so on) wrap other remotes.

## Included logos

| File name | Service | Built-in tile | Colour |
|-----------|---------|---------------|--------|
|-----------|---------|---------------|--------|

## Cloud drive

| File name       | Service                 | Built-in tile | Colour  |
|-----------------|-------------------------|---------------|---------|
| box.png         | Box                     | cloud         | #1A73C7 |
| drime.png       | Drime                   | cloud         | #7C3AED |
| drive.png       | Google Drive            | cloud         | #1E8E3E |
| dropbox.png     | Dropbox                 | cloud         | #2D5BE3 |
| fichier.png     | 1Fichier                | cloud         | #E65A28 |
| filefabric.png  | Enterprise File Fabric  | cloud         | #4A5D7A |
| filelu.png      | FileLu Cloud Storage    | cloud         | #2E7DD7 |
| filen.png       | Filen                   | cloud         | #1F2937 |
| filescom.png    | Files.com               | cloud         | #2563EB |
| gofile.png      | Gofile                  | cloud         | #3B82F6 |
| hidrive.png     | HiDrive                 | cloud         | #E2001A |
| huaweidrive.png | Huawei Drive            | cloud         | #CF0A2C |
| icloudrive.png  | iCloud Drive and Photos | cloud         | #3A8EE6 |
| internxt.png    | Internxt Drive          | cloud         | #0066FF |
| jottacloud.png  | Jottacloud              | cloud         | #6A4FB8 |
| koofr.png       | Koofr, Digi Storage     | cloud         | #2F9E6E |
| linkbox.png     | Linkbox                 | cloud         | #3BA7C9 |
| mailru.png      | Mail.ru Cloud           | cloud         | #1D6FD8 |

| File name        | Service               | Built-in tile | Colour  |
|------------------|-----------------------|---------------|---------|
| mega.png         | Mega                  | cloud         | #D9272E |
| onedrive.png     | Microsoft OneDrive    | cloud         | #0F6CBD |
| opendrive.png    | OpenDrive             | cloud         | #3E82C4 |
| pccloud.png      | Pcloud                | cloud         | #139C9C |
| pikpak.png       | PikPak                | cloud         | #3D7BE0 |
| pixeldrain.png   | Pixeldrain Filesystem | cloud         | #4F8A3C |
| premiumizeme.png | premiumize.me         | cloud         | #E0632A |
| protondrive.png  | Proton Drive          | cloud         | #6D4AFF |
| putio.png        | Put.io                | cloud         | #E3A72A |
| quatrix.png      | Quatrix by Maytech    | cloud         | #0E7490 |
| seafile.png      | seafile               | cloud         | #E06C16 |
| shade.png        | Shade FS              | cloud         | #525252 |
| sharefile.png    | Citrix Sharefile      | cloud         | #4C6A8E |
| sugarsync.png    | Sugarsync             | cloud         | #0A84C6 |
| ulozto.png       | Uloz.to               | cloud         | #E5007E |
| yandex.png       | Yandex Disk           | cloud         | #E0A100 |
| zoho.png         | Zoho                  | cloud         | #C8312B |

## Photos & media

| File name      | Service       | Built-in tile | Colour  |
|----------------|---------------|---------------|---------|
| cloudinary.png | Cloudinary    | photos        | #3448C5 |
| gphotos.png    | Google Photos | photos        | #C2185B |
| imagekit.png   | ImageKit.io   | photos        | #0450D5 |

## Object storage

| File name      | Service                                         | Built-in tile | Colour  |
|----------------|-------------------------------------------------|---------------|---------|
| azureblob.png  | Microsoft Azure Blob Storage                    | bucket        | #0F78D4 |
| azurefiles.png | Microsoft Azure Files                           | bucket        | #0F78D4 |
| b2.png         | Backblaze B2                                    | bucket        | #C8312B |
| gcs.png        | Google Cloud Storage (this is not Google Drive) | bucket        | #3367D6 |
| netstorage.png | Akamai NetStorage                               | bucket        | #0096D6 |
| oos.png        | Oracle Cloud Infrastructure Object Storage      | bucket        | #C74634 |
| qingstor.png   | QingCloud Object Storage                        | bucket        | #2D8CF0 |

| File name      | Service                                                                          | Built-in tile | Colour  |
|----------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------|---------|
| s3.png         | Amazon S3 and S3-compatible storage (AWS, Cloudflare R2, Wasabi, MinIO and more) | bucket        | #D9822B |
| sia.png        | Sia Decentralized Cloud                                                          | bucket        | #1ED660 |
| storj.png      | Storj Decentralized Cloud Storage                                                | bucket        | #2683FF |
| swift.png      | OpenStack Swift (Rackspace, OVH and more)                                        | bucket        | #B85C1E |
| tardigrade.png | Storj Decentralized Cloud Storage                                                | bucket        | #2683FF |

## Server / protocol

| File name  | Service                        | Built-in tile | Colour  |
|------------|--------------------------------|---------------|---------|
| ftp.png    | FTP                            | server        | #3B7E5B |
| hdfs.png   | Hadoop distributed file system | server        | #5E6B78 |
| http.png   | HTTP                           | globe         | #4E6A92 |
| sftp.png   | SSH/SFTP                       | server        | #0E7C86 |
| smb.png    | SMB / CIFS                     | server        | #4E6A92 |
| webdav.png | WebDAV                         | server        | #7553C0 |

## Archive

| File name           | Service          | Built-in tile | Colour  |
|---------------------|------------------|---------------|---------|
| doi.png             | DOI datasets     | archive       | #555D66 |
| internetarchive.png | Internet Archive | archive       | #555D66 |

## Local / virtual

| File name    | Service                               | Built-in tile | Colour  |
|--------------|---------------------------------------|---------------|---------|
| alias.png    | Alias for an existing remote          | folder        | #C98B1E |
| archive.png  | Read archives                         | folder        | #C98B1E |
| cache.png    | Cache a remote                        | folder        | #C98B1E |
| chunker.png  | Transparently chunk/split large files | folder        | #C98B1E |
| combine.png  | Combine several remotes into one      | folder        | #C98B1E |
| compress.png | Compress a remote                     | folder        | #C98B1E |
| crypt.png    | Encrypt/Decrypt a remote              | lock          | #5B5FC7 |
| hasher.png   | Better checksums for other remotes    | folder        | #C98B1E |
| local.png    | Local Disk                            | drive         | #5E6B78 |
| memory.png   | In memory object storage system.      | drive         | #5E6B78 |

| File name | Service                                          | Built-in tile | Colour  |
|-----------|--------------------------------------------------|---------------|---------|
| union.png | Union merges the contents of several upstream fs | folder        | #C98B1E |

# Keyboard shortcuts

| Shortcut                    | Action                                 |
|-----------------------------|----------------------------------------|
| Ctrl+T                      | Open the current remote in a new tab   |
| Ctrl+W                      | Close the current tab                  |
| Ctrl+F                      | Filter the current folder (Esc clears) |
| Ctrl+Shift+1 / Ctrl+Shift+2 | Icons view / Details view              |
| Ctrl + mouse wheel          | Bigger / smaller icons (Icons view)    |
| Enter, double-click         | Open folder (Icons view)               |
| Alt+Up                      | Parent folder                          |
| F5                          | Refresh                                |
| F7                          | New folder                             |
| F2                          | Rename                                 |
| Del                         | Delete                                 |
| Ctrl+U / Ctrl+D             | Upload / Download                      |
| Middle-click on a tab       | Close it                               |

# Troubleshooting and FAQ

## A remote shows an error or stays empty

Open Transfers or run the same remote in a console with `rcclone lsd remote:` to see rclone's message. Expired sign-ins are renewed with `rcclone config reconnect remote:.`

## Mount does not work

Install WinFsp, then try again. Mount options are in Settings.

## Windows SmartScreen blocks the app

Click More info, then Run anyway. The release checksum lets you confirm that the file is the published one.

## Large folders load slowly

Add `--fast-list` to Default rclone options for bucket-based storage (S3, B2, GCS). Some services are slow to list by nature.

## Text looks too small or too large

The app follows Windows display scaling (Settings > System > Display > Scale).

## Where do I report a problem?

Open an issue in the GitHub repository and include the output from Show Output on the transfer card.

# Security

- Credentials stay in rclone's configuration; the app never stores cloud passwords or tokens itself.
- The rclone configuration password lives only in memory and is passed via an environment variable, not on the command line.
- rclone updates: HTTPS only, SHA-256 verified, size-limited, and tested before installation.
- Folder listings use rclone's JSON output, which handles any file name safely (spaces, quotes, unusual characters).
- No shell is involved when starting rclone or a media player: arguments are passed directly, so file names cannot inject commands.
- The Windows build uses Control Flow Guard, CET shadow-stack compatibility, ASLR and DEP to make memory-corruption exploits much harder.
- Release builds are produced on GitHub's servers from the public source, with every build action pinned to an exact commit, and each release lists the SHA-256 of the zip.

# For developers

| Path                | Contents                                                                                                                                              |
|---------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| src/                | C++20 / Qt 6 source. main_window_shell.cpp builds the sidebar and pages; remote_widget.cpp the browser; theme.cpp the colours, icons and style sheet. |
| src/icons/fluently/ | Fluent UI System Icons (MIT). Every SVG here is compiled in automatically as :/fluently/<name>.svg.                                                   |
| tests/              | Unit tests for rclone output parsing (ctest).                                                                                                         |
| docs/               | Screenshots, remote-icons.md and this guide (docs/guide/build_guide.py).                                                                              |
| .github/workflows/  | Windows build, portable packaging and releases.                                                                                                       |

## Building

- Visual Studio 2022 or newer with C++ desktop tools, CMake 3.21+, Ninja, Qt 6.10+ (MSVC 64-bit, with Qt SVG).
- `cmake -S . -B build -G Ninja -DCMAKE_BUILD_TYPE=Release`
- `cmake --build build and ctest --test-dir build`

## Releasing

Update VERSION and src/resources.rc, add a CHANGELOG entry, regenerate this guide, then push a tag such as v5.0.0. GitHub Actions builds the portable zip and publishes the release.